

Greenfield GTM Engine

How I built the entire outbound motion from zero and generated \$180K+ ARR in 6 months

CASE STUDY · RASUL SHAIKH · GTM ENGINEER

\$180K+

ARR IN 6 MONTHS

40%

PIPELINE EFFICIENCY GAIN

80%

QUALIFICATION TIME CUT

1 → 4

SDR TEAM SCALED

THE PROBLEM

RemoteState had \$12.2M ARR and no outbound motion. All pipeline was coming from inbound and referrals. Leadership wanted to add \$500K ARR in 12 months from outbound. They had zero tooling, zero sequences, and one SDR doing manual LinkedIn outreach with no system behind it. The qualification process was taking 2 full days per account.

WHAT I BUILT

- Full sending infrastructure: 250+ sending domains across 3 inboxes per domain, warmup sequences across all, Smartlead configured with inbox rotation and daily limits that kept deliverability above 95%.
- Clay enrichment pipeline: Multi-source enrichment pulling from Apollo, LinkedIn, Clearbit, and web scraping. Custom OpenAI lead-scoring rubric ranking accounts by ICP fit before any human touches the list.
- SDR playbooks: Built sequence templates, objection handling guides, and reply classification rules that let the SDR team operate without hand-holding. Onboarded 3 new SDRs in week 4 using the same system.
- CRM architecture: HubSpot configured with custom deal stages, sequence-aware contact properties, and automated routing based on reply intent (Claude API parsing positive/negative/referral).
- Demand gen layer: LinkedIn Ads running retargeting to website visitors who matched the ICP. Google Ads capturing bottom-funnel search terms. Both feeding into the same HubSpot pipeline.
- Reporting: Weekly pipeline velocity dashboard showing reply rate, qualified pipeline per SDR, sequence performance by variant, and cost per SQL.

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THE RESULTS

- \$180K+ ARR generated from outbound in 6 months — on a \$0 outbound budget at the start of the engagement.
- 40% improvement in pipeline efficiency: the same number of leads produced more qualified opportunities after the scoring rubric filtered the list.
- 80% reduction in qualification time: from 2 days to 4 hours per account, driven by AI reply parsing and automated routing.
- SDR team scaled 1 → 4 in 8 weeks using documented playbooks. New reps were productive in week 1 because the system did the heavy lifting.
- Inbound-to-outbound ratio shifted from 90/10 to 65/35 within 6 months — the outbound channel was generating nearly a third of all new pipeline.

KEY LEARNINGS

- Infrastructure first, headcount second. Adding SDRs to a broken system produces mediocre results. Fixing the system first, then scaling headcount, compounds.
- Scoring before sending is not optional at scale. Without a rubric, SDRs spend 60% of their time on accounts that will never buy.
- Deliverability is a full-time job. 250+ domains sounds like overkill until you see what happens to reply rates when you skip warmup.
- The playbook is the asset, not the rep. A well-documented system means any competent rep can operate at senior-rep performance within a week.

STACK

Outbound: Clay, Smartlead (250+ domains), Apollo, HeyReach

AI: OpenAI API (lead scoring rubric), Claude API (reply classification)

CRM / Automation: HubSpot, n8n, Webhooks

Demand Gen: LinkedIn Ads, Google Ads API, GA4, SEMrush